

Private Flying Begins

The 1920s saw designers start to produce machines specifically for the private owner. Although there were still surplus military aircraft available, none was particularly economical to operate. Flying competitions were held to encourage companies to build light, more affordable planes, and to develop interest in aviation.



△ **English Electric Wren 1921**
Origin UK
Engine 8 hp ABC air-cooled flat-twin
Top speed 50 mph (80 km/h)

This very light machine, powered by a motorcycle engine, shared first prize at the Lympne aircraft trials, when it flew 87 miles (140 km) on a single gallon of gasoline.



△ **de Havilland DH53 Humming Bird 1923**
Origin UK
Engine 26 hp Blackburne Tomtit air-cooled inverted V-twin
Top speed 73 mph (118 km/h)

Another aircraft that was designed for the Lympne trials, the prototype Humming Bird was powered by a 750 cc Douglas aircraft engine, although production aircraft were fitted with a 26 hp Blackburne Tomtit inverted V-twin.



◁ **Morane Saulnier DH60M Gipsy Moth 1929**
Origin UK design/French built
Engine 100 hp de Havilland Gipsy I air-cooled in-line 4
Top speed 105 mph (169 km/h)

The Gipsy Moth was the affordable folding-wing aircraft that made private flying possible in Britain and was popular across the globe. The DH60M was a metal-frame version intended for hostile climates.



△ **Hawker Cygnet 1924**
Origin UK
Engine 34 hp Bristol Cherub III air-cooled flat-twin
Top speed 82 mph (132 km/h)

Designed by the great British designer, Sidney Camm, the Cygnet competed at the famous Lympne trials. Only two were built, and both always placed well. They came first and second in 1926.



◁ **Farman FF65 Sport 1920**
Origin France
Engine 80 hp Anzani air-cooled 6-cylinder 2-row radial
Top speed 87 mph (140 km/h)

Farman was well known for its military aircraft and airliners. The FF65 Sport is notable in that it was one of the first aircraft to be powered by a two-row radial engine.



△ **ANEC II 1923**
Origin UK
Engine 30 hp ABC Scorpion air-cooled flat-twin
Top speed 74 mph (119 km/h)

One of the earliest ultralight aircraft, the ANEC II was a slightly larger two-seat version of the original ANEC I. Designed for the 1924 Lympne trials, only one was built. It survives in the Shuttleworth Collection at Old Warden, UK.

